his statement intended ‘to make the deaf hear’ and call for revolution because ‘revolution is an alienable right of mankind’ was well-known to all.

In hindsight, this is hardly surprising, given that even as Bhagat Singh hurled down the smoke bombs from the balcony, he had shouted out, together with B.K. Dutt, who accompanied him, the slogan *Inquilab zindabad*. The phrase means ‘Long live the Revolution’. *Inquilab zindabad* was a slogan coined by the Urdu poet and Indian freedom fighter Maulana Hasrat, who was a founder of the Indian Communist Party in 1921. The adage was popularized, however, by Bhagat Singh through its repeated invocation in his speeches and writings. The Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA) adopted it as its official mantra, as did the All India Azad Muslim Conference. Thereafter, it served as a motto for the Indian Independence Movement. Today, it is even used in India as a catchphrase in the fight against bigotry and injustice. The crack of the explosion from the smoke bombs split the air, sending those nearby screaming and scrambling for cover. It was the desired effect the two revolutionaries had aimed for. Fear and panic flooded the chamber. What flooded India was the light of humanity. It is this light which the rest of this book must now explore.